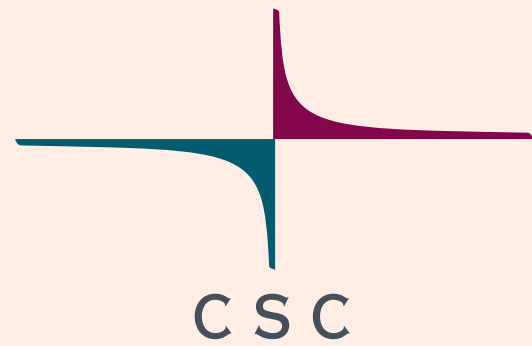




Software Management Plans - basics

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Engagement possibility:

“Do you currently support research software?” / “Have you heard about SMP before?”

Content for Today

1. Research Software: Context & Basics (10 min)
2. Why Research Software Matters (5 min)
3. Introduction to Software Management Plans (SMPs) (10 min)
4. What Does an SMP Look Like? (10 min)
5. Using SMPs in Practice (10 min)
6. Practical Guidance (10 min)
7. SMPs in Finland / Nordics (5 min)
8. Questions and Discussion
9. Resources

Meet Anna and Benji

Throughout this talk, we'll follow two researchers and their projects as running examples.

Anna – researcher in environmental sciences

Benji – PhD student in social sciences (qualitative research)

- Studies climate patterns using datasets from multiple sources
- Writes small computer programs, called scripts (using tools like R or Python), to clean and analyse her data
- Collaborates with a postdoc
- 3-year research project → publications
- Studies community responses to climate change
- Conducts interviews and focus groups; collects field notes and audio recordings
- Uses specialised software to organise and code interview transcripts
- Works with a supervisor and a research assistant
- 3-year research project → dissertation + publications

1. Research Software: Context & Basics (10 min)

- What is research software
- Who creates it (researchers, RSEs, teams)
- How it is developed (lifecycle, collaboration)
- How it is used in research

What is Research Software, and who creates it?

How is Research Software developed and used?

Engagement possibility:

“What goes wrong if software isn’t documented or maintained?” (Facilitation: Question on the slide and 1-2-3 chat)

2. Why Research Software matters (5 min)

- Research quality and reproducibility
- Sustainability and reuse
- How software is shared and cited

Quality, Reproducibility, and Reuse

Sharing and Citing Software

Engagement possibility:

“Given these challenges, how do you think we could plan software better?”
(Facilitation: Question on the slide and 1-2-3 chat)

3. Introduction to Software Management Plans (SMPs) (10min)

- What is a Software Management Plan
- Why consider it (even if not required)
- When to consider it (project stages, funding, etc.)

Engagement possibility:

“If you had to document your software for reuse, what would you include?”
(Facilitation: Question on the slide and 1-2-3 chat)

4. What Does an SMP Look Like? (10 min)

- Typical structure / key components
- Relation to:
 - Data Management Plans (DMPs)
 - Methods and protocols

Engagement possibility:

Some scenario like: “A PhD student writes analysis scripts for a project. The project ends in 2 years. What should be planned for?” (Facilitation: Question on the slide and 1-2-3 chat)

5. Using SMPs in Practice (10 min)

- Who writes/fills it (researchers, support staff)
- How to fill it/ Where to find the data?
- How to use it throughout a project
- How support staff can help

Engagement possibility:

“What is the biggest challenge you face when supporting software?”
(Facilitation: Question on the slide and 1-2-3 chat)

6. Practical Guidance (10 min)

- Practical tips
- Common challenges
- Tools, templates, and examples

Engagement possibility:

“Are SMPs already discussed in your organization?” (Facilitation: Question on the slide and 1-2-3 chat)

7. SMPs in Finland / Nordics (5 min)

- Current practices
- Policies / recommendations
- Emerging trends

8. Questions and discussion (Facilitation: Menti)

- “What part of SMPs feels most unclear?”
- “Would you realistically introduce this in your work?” → How is the SMP support organized / done in your organization?
- “What is needed to improve support?”
- “In your view, is software an accepted/appreciated/reported research output in your organization/Finland”

9. Resources

- ..



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